The Measurement Chain as a Channel

What Communications Engineering Teaches About Recursion, Residuals and Numerical Hits

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The Measurement Chain as a Channel

Abstract

Communications engineering no longer fights echoes; it measures and uses them: known pilot symbols reveal the channel, a suitable basis makes it diagonal, regeneration prevents noise from adding up, and the Shannon limit states how much information a noisy channel can deliver at most. This document transfers the four methods to the question of whether recursions are part of the measured values (Doc. 394). Results: in the ratio sector the channel is flat; with the Koide form as pilot, the lepton ratios deviate by less than $1\,\xi$. A mode-dependent channel factor is thereby limited to at most about $1\,\%$ of the correction step $100\,\xi$. In the SI sector there is exactly one pilot, α, and there cannot be more in a ratio-based theory: the only relation with an SI unit is $\alpha_{\mathrm{SI}} = \xi(E_0/1\,\mathrm{MeV})^2$, and K and the MeV anchoring are the same degree of freedom. The muon lifetime tests not K but the dimensionless ratio v/m_μ; the bound on the mode factor needs only the derived angle $2/9$. Discrete structures with small denominators survive the measurement chain; the SI correction of $1.33\,\%$ leaves denominators unambiguous only up to about 11. As a yardstick against number mysticism, a hit counts only if the measurement delivers more information than the formula contains; the Koide parameters $2/9$ and $\sqrt{2}$ pass this clearly, and so does $\alpha^{-1} = 3700/27$ when it is calculated according to its constituents $7500 \cdot (74/75)/54$ rather than as a freely searched fraction.

Status markers

[B] Algebraically proved (rearrangement without additional assumption).
[K] Numerically confirmed (check script).
[S] Assumption, open, or classification without a calculation of its own.
[X] Excluded by the calculation.
[Q] Taken from the literature, with source.

Measured values: m_e, m_μ and α from CODATA 2022 **[Q]**, $m_\tau = 1776.93 \pm 0.09$ MeV from PDG (pdgLive, 2026 edition) **[Q]**.

1 Occasion

The basic form of FFGFT calculates with ratios; a fractal correction appears only in the translation into SI units. Behind this stands the reading that the measurer stands inside the scale recursion, so that the recursion is part of every measured value. Doc. 394 showed that this reading has so far been tested on exactly one quantity, α, and that the other residuals have a different origin. What remained open was how to test the question systematically.

Communications engineering has faced the same situation for decades: a signal runs through a channel that alters it, and the receiver stands at the end of this channel, not outside it. How it deals with this yields four transferable methods. Two are directly usable as methods, channel estimation with a pilot and the Shannon balance; two are structural hints, the eigenbasis and regeneration.

2 How communications engineering deals with echoes

Besides the direct signal, a radio channel delivers delayed copies, the echoes. They used to be regarded as interference; today they are measured and used as additional signal energy **[Q]**. The *RAKE receiver* (CDMA, UMTS) picks up the delayed copies individually with several "fingers", aligns their delays and adds them with weights [2]. *OFDM* (WLAN, LTE, 5G, DVB-T) spreads the signal over many slow subcarriers; a guard interval longer than the echo delays turns the convolution with the echoes into a simple phase and amplitude rotation per subcarrier [4]. *Maximum ratio combining* and MIMO exploit several propagation paths as parallel channels [3].

What makes this possible is *channel estimation*: the transmitter sends along pilot symbols whose value the receiver knows exactly; from what arrives, it determines the channel and removes it. A second principle is *regeneration*: every repeater decides anew between 0 and 1, so noise does not accumulate along the line. What none of the methods circumvents is the *Shannon limit* $C = B \log_2(1 + S/N)$ [1]. Using echoes increases the effective ratio S/N, and modern error correction comes within fractions of a decibel of the limit [5, 6], but never beyond it. The echoes therefore do not disappear; they are measured, modelled as part of the system and exploited, and the bound remains.

3 Channel estimation with a pilot

Method and condition

Transferred, this means: the measurement chain is the channel H that turns the value of the basic form y_{th} into the measured value $y_{\text{meas}} = H\, y_{\text{th}}$. A pilot is a quantity whose value is fixed algebraically and exactly in the basic form. H follows from it. With this H one calculates the other quantities back. If one common H explains several residuals, there is a uniform recursion; if each quantity needs its own H, there is none, and one then knows it for certain. The condition for this is strict: the pilot must be exact independently. If it contains a model error itself, the channel estimate absorbs this error and the calculation becomes circular.

Ratio sector: the channel is flat

The pilot in the ratio sector is the Koide form with $\theta = 2/9$ and $d/c = \sqrt{2}$ (Docs. 353, 367),

$$\sqrt{m_k} \;\propto\; 1 + \sqrt{2}\,\cos\!\left(\tfrac{2}{9} + \tfrac{2\pi k}{3}\right). \tag{1}$$

It fixes the ratios m_μ/m_e and m_τ/m_μ without any measured value. The channel factor is then

$$H_{\mu e} - 1 = -0.074\,\xi, \qquad H_{\tau\mu} - 1 = -0.16 \pm 0.38\,\xi \tag{2}$$

[K], for the muon-electron ratio with a measurement uncertainty of only 2×10^{-8}. Both factors lie below $1\,\xi$, more than a hundred times below the SI correction step $100\,\xi$. In the ratio sector the channel is therefore flat: a recursion of the measurement chain is not visible there. This is to be expected, since a common factor cancels in ratios (A040, Doc. 070).

Pilot with a model error: the ladder

If the lepton ladder $m_i \propto r_i\,\xi^{p_i}$ is taken as the pilot instead of the Koide form, it lies $39.10\,\xi$ and $77.56\,\xi$ above the measured ratios **[K]**; each generation then requires its own channel factor. This, however, is not a channel. Ladder and Koide form differ without any measured value by $39.02\,\xi$ and $77.40\,\xi$ (Doc. 394) **[K]**: the apparent channel is the model error of the pilot. This is exactly what the condition in Section 3.1 warns against. In the language of channel estimation, the falling residuals ε_i from Doc. 352 are the result of an inexact pilot.

SI sector: one pilot, no test value

In the SI sector, α is the only pilot without a fitted factor. It estimates the channel very precisely: $K = \xi\, m_e m_\mu\, \alpha^{-1} = 0.986501$, that is $n = 101.25$ in $K = 1 - n\,\xi$, with an uncertainty below 3×10^{-8} **[K]**; if the energy unit is fixed via $m_e m_\mu = 54$, it is $n = 100.056$ (Doc. 394) **[K]**. Whether the same K also carries other SI quantities cannot be tested, because a second pilot is missing: E_P and G depend on the fitted factor 10 in v/E_P (Docs. 149, 383), and v is a convention of the Standard Model (R112). Channel estimation is thus possible, its test is not. Section 7 shows that a second SI pilot cannot exist in FFGFT at all.

4 Eigenbasis: one channel factor per mode

OFDM switches to a basis in which the channel becomes diagonal; the convolution with echoes turns into a simple factor per subcarrier. FFGFT already has such a basis: the modes on T^4 with their mode-bound time scale $\tilde{T} = 1/m$. A measurement recursion would there be

a factor κ_i of its own per mode, and this would lead one to expect generation-dependent corrections **[S]**.

The pilot from Section 3.2 limits this possibility. A difference between the channel factors of two modes appears directly in the ratio of their masses. If the Koide form holds exactly, it follows that

$$|\kappa_\mu - \kappa_e| \le 0.074\,\xi, \qquad |\kappa_\tau - \kappa_\mu| \le 0.92\,\xi\,(2\sigma) \tag{3}$$

[K]. A mode-dependent part of the measurement recursion is thereby limited to at most about $1\,\%$ of the correction step $100\,\xi$. The SI correction must be practically common to the three charged leptons; this supports the uniform rule. The generation-dependent residuals of the ladder do not need this basis; they are the distance from the Koide form (Section 3.3). The bound holds under the assumption that the Koide form is exact; if it is not, the calculation only limits the sum of the Koide residual and the mode factor **[S]**. Section 7 shows that the main part of the bound already holds with the derived angle $2/9$ alone.

The Koide form itself can also be fitted freely to the measured values. With both parameters free, one obtains $\theta = 0.2222248 \pm 0.0000063$ and $d/c = 1.4142089 \pm 0.000011$, that is $2/9$ and $\sqrt{2}$ each within one standard deviation, the uncertainty coming solely from the tau mass **[K]**.

5 Regeneration: the discrete survives the measurement chain

Digital transmission beats noise because a new decision is made at every node. This agrees with Doc. 343: the discreteness of FFGFT is topological; it lies in winding numbers and integer structures, not in the dynamics. Transferred, this means: exact rational ratios and integers can be recovered from a noisy measured value as long as the tolerance is smaller than the distance to the nearest competitor. The limit for this is the Farey height from Doc. 343,

$$Q_c = \frac{\pi}{\sqrt{6\,\varepsilon}}, \tag{4}$$

up to which fractions remain unambiguous at relative tolerance ε:

Tolerance	ε	Q_c
SI correction $100\,\xi$	$1.33\,\%$	11.1
m_τ/m_μ	5.1×10^{-5}	180
m_μ/m_e	2.2×10^{-8}	8700
α	1.5×10^{-10}	1.0×10^{5}

[K] A clear rule for the presentation follows from this. If a ratio is passed through the SI correction of $1.33\,\%$, only denominators up to about 11 remain unambiguous; the denominators 9, 5 and 8 of the basic form survive this, the 75 of the rotation number does not. In the basic form itself, without correction, the ratios are by contrast measured so precisely that large denominators could also be recovered. Continuing corrections accumulate errors; exact ratios are preserved. This supports the guideline of building the theory from the ratio-based basic form and applying corrections only at the end **[S]**.

6 Shannon balance against number mysticism

A measurement with relative precision δ delivers, about a constant whose value is known beforehand only to within a decade, roughly

$$I = \log_2 \frac{\ln 10}{2\,\delta} \text{ bits}. \tag{5}$$

A formula itself contains information; Doc. 393 measures it as complexity C in bits, growing with numerator, denominator, root and exponent. If the space of possible formulas contains more bits than the measurement, some combination inevitably hits. A formal criterion follows from this: a hit counts only if the surplus $I - C$ is clearly positive. The deviation from the measured value is taken as δ, but at most the measurement uncertainty.

Hit	I	C	$I-C$
$\alpha^{-1} = 7400/54$ $(= 3700/27)$	17.2	5.8	+11.5
as a freely searched fraction $3700/27$	17.2	16.6	+0.6
$v/E_P = \xi^4/(5\pi)$	9.0	6.3	+2.6
$M_W/M_Z = \sqrt{7/9}$	10.8	5.4	+5.4
$m_e m_\mu$ close to the integer 54	5.8	0	+5.8
Koide $\theta = 2/9$	15.3	4.2	+11.1
Koide $d/c = \sqrt{2}$	17.2	2.0	+15.2

[K] For $3700/27$ the decisive point is how the formula is counted. As a freely searched fraction it contains almost as much information as the deviation of 7.6 ppm provides and does not count; this is how the null test from Doc. 393 ($p \approx 0.47$) calculates. In the corpus, however, $3700/27$ is only the reduction of $7500 \cdot (74/75)/54$: $7500 = 1/\xi$ and $74/75$ come from the basic form, the only new element is the integer 54. Counted this way, more than 11 bits of surplus remain; estimated directly, $7400/\alpha^{-1}$ lies this close to an integer with a probability of about 8×10^{-4} (Doc. 394) **[K]**. The precondition is that $74/75$ was fixed independently of α (Docs. 133, 300). The closeness of the mass product to 54 delivers just under 6 bits, corresponding to a chance probability of about $1.7\,\%$ (Doc. 394). Far ahead are the two Koide parameters with 11 and 15 bits of surplus; they are the strongest numerical structure of the lepton sector. It should be noted that $d/c = \sqrt{2}$ is equivalent to the Koide relation $Q = 2/3$, known since 1982 [7]; the surplus demonstrates the structure of the data, not yet its derivation from FFGFT. That derivation is given for $\theta = 2/9$ in Doc. A110 and for the amplitude in Docs. 353 and 367 (R150).

The criterion is rough. It does not count how many formulas of equal complexity exist, and it depends on the chosen bit measure **[S]**. For individual hits it therefore does not replace the null test from Doc. 393, but it shows at a glance where a closer test is worthwhile and where it is not.

7 What can be resolved

There is no second pilot in the SI sector

The only relation in the corpus in which an SI unit appears explicitly is $\alpha_{\mathrm{SI}} = \xi(E_0/1\,\mathrm{MeV})^2$ (Docs. 010, 011, 014, 137, 313, 365, 384, 386). All other statements of FFGFT are pure numbers, ratios of two quantities of the same dimension; a common factor cancels in them (A040) **[B]**. With $\hbar = c = 1$ a single dimension remains, energy, and hence a single unit. The SI sector therefore has exactly one degree of freedom: the factor that binds the basic form to the MeV. K and the MeV anchoring are the same number, and the one measurement α fixes it. A second pilot that could test this number cannot exist in a ratio-based theory **[B]**. The assignment from Doc. 386, according to which the correction sits on the side of the unit, is thus no longer a mere assumption but follows from the structure; what remains open is only whether the value $74/75$ is geometrically justified, and α tests this **[S]**.

The muon lifetime is not an SI pilot either. With $G_F = 1/(\sqrt{2}\,v^2)$,

$$\frac{\Gamma_\mu}{m_\mu} = \frac{1}{384\,\pi^3}\Big(\frac{m_\mu}{v}\Big)^4 \tag{6}$$

up to radiative corrections **[Q]**; τ_μ therefore tests only the dimensionless ratio v/m_μ. The ladder gives $5/(16\,\xi) = 2343.75$ for it, the measured value is 2330.34: a residual of $+43\,\xi$ without K and $+145\,\xi$ with K **[K]**. Without K the ladder lies 3.4 times closer, as required by the rule according to which K has no place in ratios. The residual itself is the known error of the ladder: relative to v, $+82\,\xi$ for the electron, $+43\,\xi$ for the muon and $-34\,\xi$ for the tau, with the distances of 39 and $77\,\xi$ between ladder and Koide form **[K]**. τ_μ thus tests the normalisation of the ladder to v, not the factor K.

The bound hardly needs the Koide amplitude

The bound in Section 4 assumed both Koide parameters to be exact. The corpus derives the angle $\theta = 2/9$ (Doc. A110); the justification of the amplitude $d/c = \sqrt{2}$ is open (R150). If the amplitude is left free, it absorbs part of the residuals, and only one combination of the mode factors remains bound. The amplitude, however, shifts almost only the muon-to-electron ratio ($\partial \ln\big(m_\mu/m_e\big)/\partial a = 32.6$ against 1.8 for the tau-to-muon ratio) **[K]**. The bound combination is therefore almost exactly the difference between tau and muon:

assumed exact	tau–muon	muon–electron
$\theta = 2/9$ and $d/c = \sqrt{2}$	$\leq 0.92\,\xi$	$\leq 0.074\,\xi$
only $\theta = 2/9$	$\leq 0.91\,\xi$	not bound
only $d/c = \sqrt{2}$	$\leq 0.92\,\xi$	not bound
neither	not bound	not bound

[K] The central statement, that a mode-dependent part of the measurement recursion amounts to at most about $1\,\%$ of the correction step $100\,\xi$, therefore depends only on the derived angle $2/9$. Only the finer bound between muon and electron additionally needs the amplitude. If both parameters are free, there is no bound: two parameters always fit two ratios exactly.

8 Conclusion

Communications engineering does not fight the recursion of the channel; it measures it with pilots and removes it, while the Shannon limit remains. Transferred to FFGFT, this yields a clear picture. In the ratio sector the channel is flat: with the Koide form as pilot no residual above $1\,\xi$ remains, and a mode-dependent part of the measurement recursion is limited to about $1\,\%$ of the correction step. The generation-dependent residuals of the ladder are the error of an inexact pilot, not a channel. In the SI sector there is exactly one pilot, α, and there cannot be a second one: the only relation with an SI unit fixes the one degree of freedom in which K and the MeV anchoring coincide. The muon lifetime tests the normalisation of the ladder to v, not K. Discrete structures with small denominators survive the measurement chain; this is why the presentation belongs in the basic form. And a numerical hit counts only if the measurement delivers more information than the formula contains.

What remains open is whether the value $74/75$, which α tests, is geometrically justified (R135), and the derivation of the Koide amplitude (R150); only the finer bound between muon and electron still depends on it **[S]**.

Check script: `2/python/Dok395_Skripte/pruef_395_messkette_kanal.py`

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